

D432

HR Compliance and Employee Relations

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 30-employee accounting firm that recently won a best-workplace award declines to hire a qualified applicant because she wears a hijab, citing its “polished image” dress code. Which statement is most accurate?

- A. The firm is too small; Title VII applies only at 50 or more employees.
- B. This is likely religious discrimination under Title VII; the firm must accommodate religious dress unless it causes undue hardship.
- C. The ADA is the law that governs this decision.
- D. It is lawful, because dress codes always override religious practice.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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2.

A warehouse employee with a back condition asks for a lifting-assist device so she can keep doing her job. The company has 200 employees and a new CEO who starts next month. What should HR do first?

- A. Always grant exactly the device she named.
- B. Deny it, since the condition did not happen at work.
- C. Begin the interactive process to identify an effective reasonable accommodation.
- D. Wait for the new CEO to set a policy.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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3.

A nonexempt clinic receptionist, well liked after three years on the job, earns \$20 an hour and worked 46 hours in one workweek. What is her gross pay for the week?

- A. \$1,040
- B. \$920
- C. \$1,380
- D. \$980

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nonexempt worker earned \$1,045 for a 45-hour workweek with no other pay. What is the regular hourly rate?

- A.** \$23.22
- B.** \$33.00
- C.** \$26.13
- D.** \$22.00

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An employee in the marketing department of a 60-employee company, all at one site, has worked there 14 months and logged 1,400 hours in the past year. She requests leave for the birth of her child. What is she entitled to under FMLA?

- A.** Up to 12 weeks of paid leave.
- B.** Nothing, because marketing roles are excluded.
- C.** Up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave.
- D.** Nothing, because she needs two years of service.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company with 300 employees at one site reviews four leave requests. Which employee is NOT eligible for FMLA leave?

- A.** An employee with 2 years of service and 1,300 hours
- B.** An employee with 11 months of service and 1,100 hours
- C.** An employee with 3 years of service and 1,500 hours who used FMLA last year
- D.** A part-time employee with 18 months of service and 1,260 hours

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An employee complains to HR that her manager makes sexist jokes. HR investigates and finds the complaint unsubstantiated. The next week the manager, who has 15 years of tenure, removes her from a high-profile project. What is the main risk?

- A. Retaliation, because a good-faith complaint is protected even if it was not substantiated.
- B. The manager's tenure protects his staffing decisions.
- C. No risk, because the complaint was unfounded.
- D. Risk arises only if she is fired.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is protected activity under federal anti-discrimination law?

- A. Posting that the CEO is a poor golfer
- B. Refusing to follow a lawful safety rule
- C. Complaining that the break-room coffee is bad
- D. Serving as a witness in a coworker's EEOC investigation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A supervisor tells a subordinate that her promotion depends on her going on dates with him. The company's handbook includes an anti-harassment policy. What type of harassment is this?

- A. Quid pro quo harassment
- B. Hostile work environment
- C. Covered only because the handbook policy exists
- D. Not harassment unless it happens repeatedly

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Coworkers repeatedly post offensive jokes about an employee's national origin. No job benefit is tied to the conduct. What type of harassment is this?

- A. Hostile work environment
- B. Quid pro quo
- C. Not harassment, since no supervisor is involved
- D. Disparate impact

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An at-will employee at a privately held manufacturer is fired right after refusing to falsify safety inspection records. The state recognizes the public-policy exception. Which analysis is best?

- A.** Lawful, because the company is privately held.
- B.** Likely wrongful termination under the public-policy exception.
- C.** Unlawful only if a union contract covers the job.
- D.** Lawful, since at-will means any firing is always legal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An employee at a company of about 500 people reports that a coworker has threatened her and asks HR to promise that no one will ever learn she complained. What should HR do?

- A.** Promise total secrecy so she feels safe.
- B.** Let the accused coworker’s manager investigate alone.
- C.** Explain that information will be shared only as needed to investigate, promise no retaliation, and investigate promptly and impartially.
- D.** Wait to see whether the threats happen again.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 30-employee accounting firm ~~that recently won a best workplace award~~ declines to hire a qualified applicant because she wears a hijab, citing its “polished image” dress code. Which statement is most accurate?

Target word: legal analysis **Decides:** Title VII covers 15+ employees and requires religious accommodation.

A	Wrong stem number	Title VII applies at 15 employees; 50 is the FMLA threshold.
B	Correct	A 30-person employer is covered, and an image preference is not undue hardship.
C	Confusion set	The ADA covers disability, not religion.
D	Absolute language	Dress codes must yield to religious accommodation absent undue hardship.

2. Answer C Concept 2

A warehouse employee with a back condition asks for a lifting-assist device so she can keep doing her job. The company has 200 employees ~~and a new CEO who starts next month~~. What should HR do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** A disability-related accommodation request.

A	Absolute language	The employer may choose among effective accommodations.
B	Adjacent category	Confuses ADA accommodation with workers’ compensation.
C	Correct	The ADA calls for a good-faith dialogue with the employee.
D	Camouflage	Leadership timing does not pause the legal duty.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A nonexempt clinic receptionist, ~~well liked after three years on the job~~, earns \$20 an hour and worked 46 hours in one workweek. What is her gross pay for the week?

Target word: weekly gross pay **Decides:** 40 hours at \$20 plus 6 hours at \$30.

A	Confusion set	Pays the 6 extra hours at double time.
B	Dropped element	$46 \times \$20$ drops the overtime premium.
C	Adjacent category	Pays all 46 hours at time-and-a-half.
D	Correct	$40 \times \$20 = \800 ; $6 \times \$30 = \180 ; total \$980.

4. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A nonexempt worker earned \$1,045 for a 45-hour workweek with no other pay. What is the regular hourly rate?

Target word: solve for the regular rate **Decides:** $40r + 5(1.5r) = 47.5r = \$1,045$.

A	Dropped element	$\$1,045 / 45$ drops the overtime premium.
B	Confusion set	That is the overtime rate, not the regular rate.
C	Wrong stem number	$\$1,045 / 40$ ignores the 5 extra hours.
D	Correct	$\$1,045 / 47.5 = \22.00 .

5. Answer C Concept 4

An employee ~~in the marketing department~~ of a 60-employee company, all at one site, has worked there 14 months and logged 1,400 hours in the past year. She requests leave for the birth of her child. What is she entitled to under FMLA?

Target word: FMLA entitlement **Decides:** All three eligibility tests are met.

A	Adjacent category	FMLA leave is unpaid; pay depends on other policies or state law.
B	Camouflage	Department does not affect eligibility.
C	Correct	50+ employees, 12+ months, 1,250+ hours; birth is a qualifying reason.
D	Wrong stem number	The requirement is 12 months.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A company with 300 employees at one site reviews four leave requests. Which employee is NOT eligible for FMLA leave?

Target word: reverse: find the ineligible employee **Decides:** Fails the 12-month and 1,250-hour tests.

A	Inverted operation	Meets every test.
B	Correct	Short of both the 12-month and 1,250-hour tests.
C	Confusion set	Past use does not remove eligibility; entitlement resets each 12-month period.
D	Adjacent category	Part-time status does not matter; the hours test is met.

7. Answer A Concept 5

An employee complains to HR that her manager makes sexist jokes. HR investigates and finds the complaint unsubstantiated. The next week the manager, ~~who has 15 years of tenure~~, removes her from a high-profile project. What is the main risk?

Target word: legal risk **Decides:** A good-faith complaint is protected activity.

A	Correct	Adverse action soon after protected activity suggests retaliation.
B	Camouflage	Tenure does not excuse retaliation.
C	Dropped element	Drops the good-faith protection.
D	Adjacent category	Any action that would deter a reasonable employee can count.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which of these is protected activity under federal anti-discrimination law?

Target word: reverse: find the protected activity **Decides:** Participation in a discrimination proceeding.

A	Confusion set	Personal criticism unrelated to discrimination is not EEO-protected.
B	Inverted operation	Refusing lawful rules is misconduct, not protected activity.
C	Adjacent category	Not opposition to an unlawful practice.
D	Correct	Participation in an EEO proceeding is protected.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A supervisor tells a subordinate that her promotion depends on her going on dates with him. ~~The company's handbook includes an anti-harassment policy.~~ What type of harassment is this?

Target word: harassment type **Decides:** A job benefit is tied to the conduct.

A	Correct	A promotion is conditioned on submitting to the supervisor's advances.
B	Confusion set	That type does not require a tied job benefit.
C	Camouflage	The law applies with or without a policy.
D	Adjacent category	Repetition matters for hostile environment; a single quid pro quo demand is enough.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

Coworkers repeatedly post offensive jokes about an employee's national origin. No job benefit is tied to the conduct. What type of harassment is this?

Target word: reverse: from conduct to type **Decides:** Pervasive conduct, no job benefit tied.

A	Correct	Repeated, unwelcome conduct based on a protected trait.
B	Inverted operation	Requires a job benefit tied to the conduct.
C	Dropped element	Coworker harassment counts if the employer knew or should have known.
D	Adjacent category	Disparate impact concerns neutral policies with unequal effects.

11. Answer B Concept 7

An at-will employee ~~at a privately held manufacturer~~ is fired right after refusing to falsify safety inspection records. The state recognizes the public-policy exception. Which analysis is best?

Target word: legality of the firing **Decides:** Fired for refusing to break the law.

A	Camouflage	Ownership type does not remove the exception.
B	Correct	Firing someone for refusing to break the law violates public policy.
C	Adjacent category	The public-policy exception applies without a contract.
D	Absolute language	At-will has important exceptions.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An employee ~~at a company of about 500 people~~ reports that a coworker has threatened her and asks HR to promise that no one will ever learn she complained. What should HR do?

Target word: HR response **Decides:** Confidentiality cannot be absolute in an investigation.

A	Absolute language	A fair investigation usually requires some disclosure.
B	Adjacent category	Risks a biased, non-impartial process.
C	Correct	Honest limits on confidentiality plus a prompt, fair process.
D	Dropped element	Drops the duty to act promptly on a threat.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	3	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Title VII and religious accommodation	Title VII covers employers with 15 or more employees and bars discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, or national origin; religious practices must be accommodated unless that causes undue hardship.	Assuming a dress code or “image” policy overrides religious practice.	A hiring or dress-code decision tied to religious dress or practice.
2	ADA interactive process	When an employee with a disability asks for help, the employer engages in an interactive process to find an effective reasonable accommodation.	Denying outright, or thinking the employee’s exact request must always be granted.	An accommodation request linked to a medical condition.
3	FLSA overtime	Nonexempt employees earn at least 1.5 times their regular rate for hours over 40 in a workweek; exemption depends on duties and salary, not title.	Paying straight time, or paying overtime on all hours.	Hourly rate and total hours above 40.
4	FMLA eligibility	FMLA gives up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave to employees with 12 months of service and 1,250 hours in the past year at a site with 50 or more employees within 75 miles.	Thinking FMLA leave is paid, or that part-timers are automatically excluded.	Headcount, tenure, and hours given with a leave reason.
5	Retaliation	Adverse action against someone for protected activity (a good-faith complaint or participating in an investigation) is illegal even if the underlying complaint is not proven.	Believing an unfounded complaint removes retaliation risk.	A complaint followed shortly by a negative job action.
6	Quid pro quo vs. hostile environment	Quid pro quo ties a job benefit to submission to sexual conduct; a hostile environment is severe or pervasive unwelcome conduct based on a protected trait.	Mixing the two, or thinking one quid pro quo demand is not enough.	Whether a job benefit is tied to the conduct.
7	At-will exceptions	At-will employment allows firing for almost any reason, except illegal reasons such as discrimination, retaliation, violations of public policy, or breach of an implied contract.	Believing at-will means any firing is legal.	A firing right after the employee refused to break the law.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Sound workplace investigations	Investigate promptly and impartially, document findings, keep information need-to-know, and prohibit retaliation; never promise total confidentiality.	Promising the complainant that no one will ever know.	A complainant asking for absolute secrecy.

Course scope (public description): Compliance and employee relations are at the core of creating workplaces that are both legally sound and positive for employees. This course equips you with knowledge of the laws and ethical requirements that guide HR practices, while also showing you how to build trust and resolve conflicts. By mastering this balance, you will be prepared to serve as both a compliance guardian and an advocate for employees.